

Early childhood teaching staff

June 2025 ECE Census results¹

There were

33,712

teaching staff² at licensed early childhood services.

There were

24,167

qualified teaching staff.³

There were

3,554

educators⁴ at licensed home-based services.

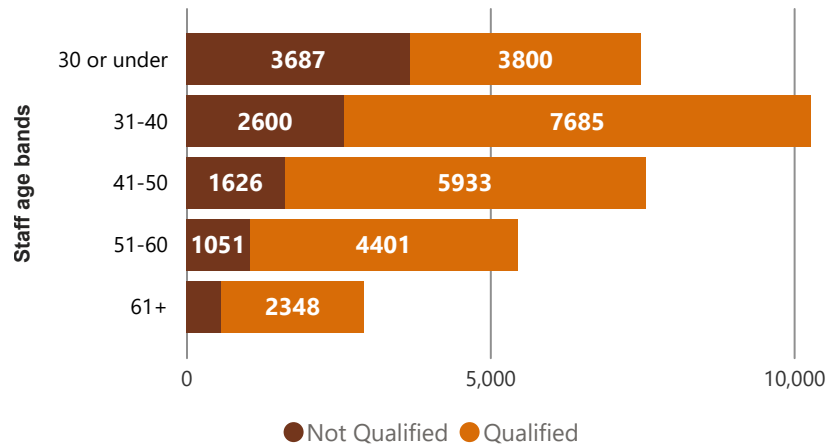
The number of qualified teaching staff increased by 2%, from 23,687 in 2024 to 24,167 in 2025; unqualified teaching staff decreased by 0.7% from, 9,610 to 9,545.

The proportion of teaching staff that were qualified increased by 1 percentage point to 72% in 2025.

Teaching staff age

- The number of teaching staff increased by 1%, from 33,297 in 2024, to 33,712 in 2025.
- 97% of teaching staff were female.
- 53% of teaching staff were in the age band of 31-50 years (17,844 teaching staff).
- Older teaching staff (51-70 years) were more likely than younger teaching staff (20-50 years) to be qualified.

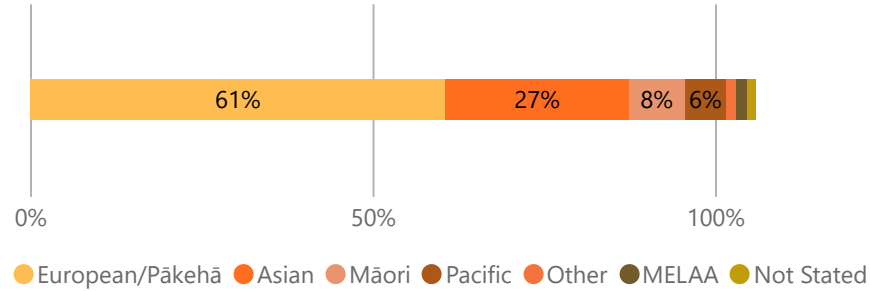
Number of teaching staff by age band



Teaching staff ethnicity⁵

- 61% of the workforce reported European/Pākehā ethnicity; a 1.6 pp⁶ decrease from 2024.

Proportion of teaching staff by ethnicity



Proportion of qualified teachers by ethnic group

Ethnic group	Proportion qualified	PP difference from last year
Māori	68%	↑ 3%
MELAA ⁷	51%	↑ 3%
Pacific	68%	↑ 5%
European/Pākehā	74%	↑ 9%
Asian	70%	↑ 11%

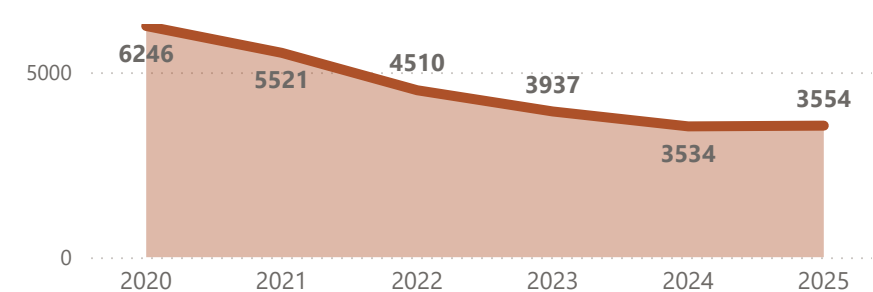
Home-based educators

- The number of home-based educators at licensed home-based services increased by 0.6% from 3,534 in 2024 to 3,554 in 2025.
- 96% of educators were female.

Compared to 2024, the proportion of home-based educators with:

- home-based qualifications increased by 6 pp to 70%.
- ECE or primary qualifications increased by 1 pp to 10%.
- in training towards ECE/home-based qualifications remained at 8%.
- no qualifications decreased by 7 pp to 12%.

Time series of number of home-based educators



¹Data is from the Ministry of Education's annual Early Childhood Census, held from 23-29 June 2025. Further information can be found on [Education Counts](#). ²Teaching staff are defined as those staff who have a teaching role – ECE teachers and home-based coordinators. Staff at playcentre and home-based educators are not included in this definition. Data on kaiako at Kōhanga Reo is not included in the ECE Census reporting. ³To be qualified, teaching staff must hold ECE or primary teaching qualifications that lead to registration with the Teaching Council of Aotearoa New Zealand. ⁴Home-based educator numbers are separate from teaching staff numbers. For more information, go to: [Home-based staff qualification – Education in New Zealand](#). ⁵Teaching staff can have more than one ethnicity, therefore, total percentages exceed 100%. The denominator for ethnicity percentages is the total number of teaching staff. ⁶PP is short for percentage point. ⁷MELAA is short for Middle-Eastern, Latin American and African.